Ideation Phase
Define the Problem Statements

Date	31 January 2025
Team ID	
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Customer Problem Statement Template:

Creating a customer problem statement helps a team understand the issue from the point of view of the people affected by it. It keeps the focus on what matters to them, gives everyone a shared description of the problem, and makes it easier to judge which ideas are worth building.
For this project, the problem statements describe how employees, approving managers and IT procurement staff experience the current process for ordering standard laptops, and where Flow Designer automation can help.

Customer Problem Statements

Problem Statement (PS)	I am	I am trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	A new employee who needs a standard laptop	Get a laptop ordered and delivered before my start date	The request needs several manual approvals and follow-ups	Requests are handled by email and each step waits on a person	Anxious and unproductive on my first days
PS-2	A department manager approving requests for my team	Approve laptop requests for my team quickly	I receive requests with missing details and repeated reminders, even for standard models	There is no rule to pre-approve eligible roles and budget details are not shown in the request	Overloaded and unsure that I am approving within budget
PS-3	An IT procurement coordinator	Fulfil laptop orders accurately from stock or vendors	I re-enter request details, check inventory by hand and chase order status	The steps from request to delivery are not connected in one automated flow	Frustrated and stretched by repetitive work

Tip: Each statement follows the same pattern: who the person is, what they are trying to do, what gets in the way, why it happens, and how it feels. Read across a row to get one complete problem statement.

Selected Problem Statement

Problem statement for the brainstorm

PS-1, PS-2 and PS-3 point to the same root cause: a request that depends on manual steps between people. They are combined into one problem statement that guides the brainstorm.

PROBLEM

How might we automate standard laptop orders in ServiceNow using Flow Designer, so employees receive approved devices faster and IT spends less time on repetitive procurement work?

What a good outcome looks like

- Employees can request a standard laptop from one catalog item and see its status.
- Eligible requests move through approval with little or no manual chasing.
- Stock checks, purchase orders and asset records are created automatically.

Screenshots

Screenshots from Flow Designer showing the automation built to address the selected problem statement.

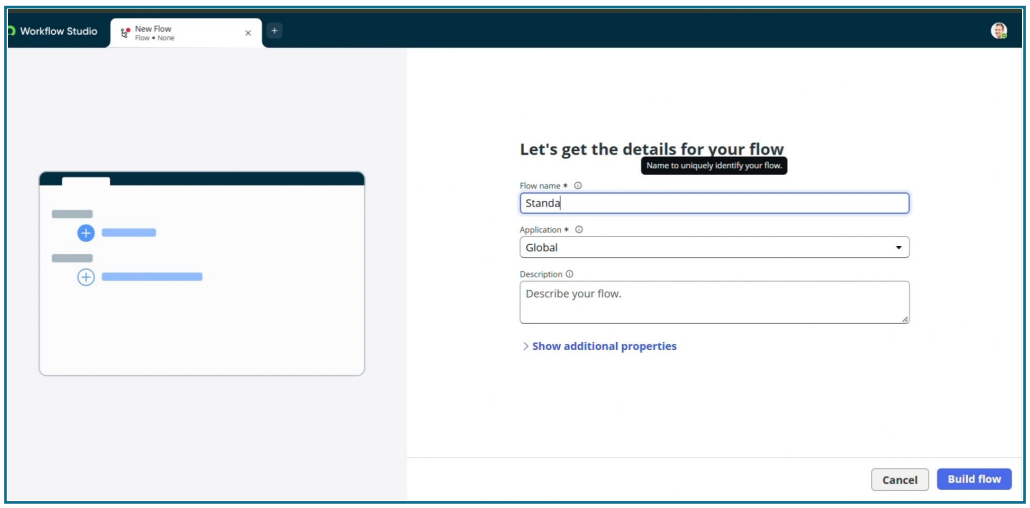


Figure 1: Creating the "Standard laptop tasks" flow in Workflow Studio

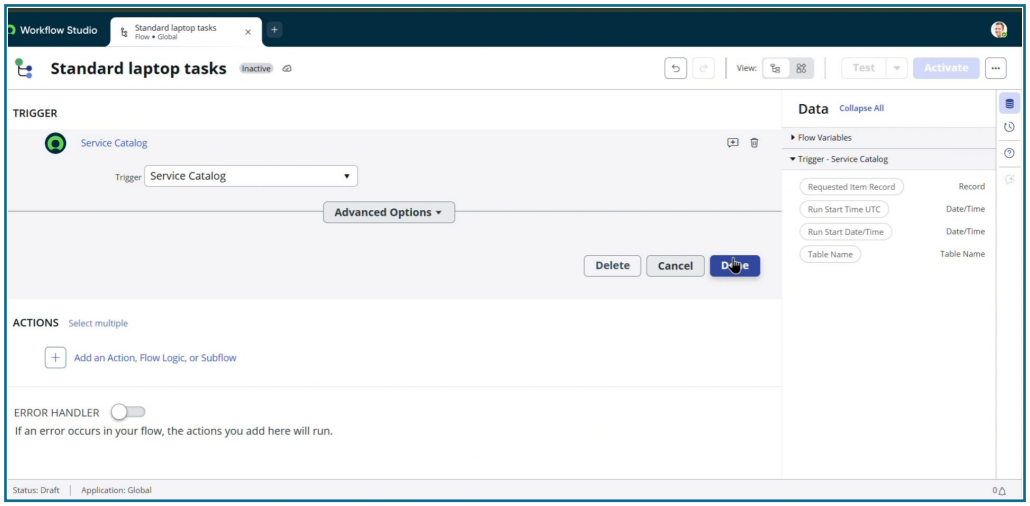


Figure 2: Flow trigger set to Service Catalog

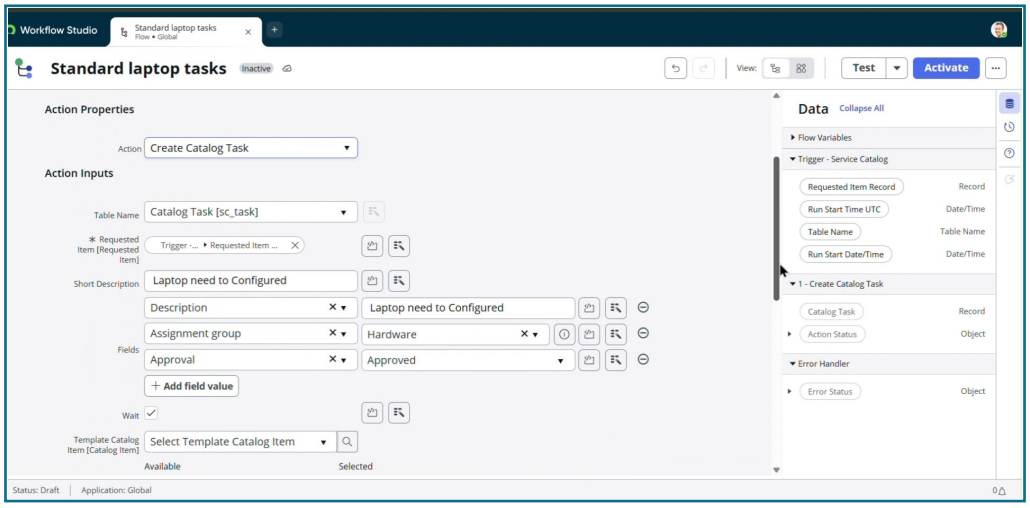


Figure 3: Create Catalog Task action configured with description, assignment group and approval